

Nirbhaya Fund

UPSC Economy Notes

Nirbhaya Fund was established in 2013, in the aftermath of the December 2012 Delhi gangrape and murder case. Nirbhaya (which literally means fearless) was given as the victim's name to conceal victim's identity. People flocked to the streets for weeks, not just in Delhi but also in outlying locations. The Government of India established the 'Nirbhaya Fund' to pursue measures targeted at improving the safety and security of women in the country.

All aspects of Nirbhaya Fund are important for civil services and competitive exams like SSC, State civil services, etc. Testbook produces the highest quality notes for civil service candidates. Examine important aspects of Indian economics from the standpoint of [UPSC exams](#).

Check out [List of Laws Protecting Women & Children in India](#) here.

Nirbhaya Fund

- Since April 1, 2015, one of the Nirbhaya Fund's projects, the "One Stop Centre (OSC) Scheme," has been implemented across the country.
- As of May 2022, 704 OSCs have been activated, and over three lakh women have benefited from their services.
- OSCs aim to provide women who have experienced abuse with a variety of integrated services under one roof, such as police facilitation, medical help, legal and psycho-social counselling, and temporary refuge.
- OSCs must be established within a two-kilometer radius of hospitals or medical facilities, either in newly constructed buildings of authorised design or in pre-existing buildings.
- One Stop Centres (OSC) are being established in all districts of the country as part of the initiative.
- In collaboration with the concerned Ministries/Departments/Implementing Agencies, an Empowered Committee (EC) of officials formed under the Nirbhaya Framework evaluates and approves proposals for funding under the Nirbhaya Fund.

Also check [National Commission for Women \(NCW\)](#) here.

Funding Pattern

The below standard funding pattern will be followed:

- 60:40 for all States
- 90:10 for States with difficult terrains

- 100% for UTs
- Few initiatives are 100% funded

The funds for the projects shall be released following the procedure prescribed in GFR 2005.

One-Stop Center Scheme:

- To address the issue of violence against women, the Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD) maintains a centrally backed scheme.
- It is part of the National Mission for Women's Empowerment, which also includes the Indira Gandhi Matritav Sahyaog Yojana.
- A one-stop center will be established around the country to provide complete support and help to women who have been abused under one roof, both in private and public settings.
- The Nirbhaya Fund and the central government are both sponsors of the scheme.

Also, check [National Women's Day](#) here!

Significant Features of Nirbhaya Fund

- The Centre grants money to states through the Nirbhaya Fund, which they then spend on programmes aimed at safeguarding women's protection.
- The Women and Child Development Ministry is the nodal body for Nirbhaya Fund expenditure.
- Previously, it was the one responsible for providing cash, but now it evaluates the programmes presented to it by the states under the Nirbhaya scheme, approves them, and recommends them to the Department of Economic Affairs for funding allocation.
- Only approximately 20% of the money provided by the Union Women and Child Development Ministry has been used by the states.
- In the instance of the Union Home Ministry, the states have filed utilization certifications for less than 9% of the Nirbhaya Fund money.

Monitoring And Evaluation:

- In collaboration with the relevant Central Ministries/Departments, the MWCD is responsible for reviewing and monitoring the progress of sanctioned projects/schemes under the Nirbhaya Fund.
- The monitoring and reporting method to be used at the State Government/UT level, as well as at the level of the relevant Central Government Ministry/Department, should be included in the proposal.
- Strict monitoring will be implemented for all applications, including those that have already been evaluated by the EC and monies have been distributed to the corresponding Ministries/Departments or States/UTs.

Read about [National Girl Child Day](#) here!

Project Contours

- Proposed projects under the Nirbhaya Fund should have the following features:

1. Direct impact on safety and security concerns of women
 2. Optimum use of existing infrastructure
 3. Innovative use of technology
 4. No duplication of existing government schemes/programmes
 5. Provision for real time intervention as far as possible
 6. Strict privacy and confidentiality of women's identity and information
 7. Defined role of all stakeholders
- Inputs – required manpower, physical assets, financial resources etc.
 - Activities – to be undertaken during the project cycle. E.g. training, building infrastructure etc.
 - Outputs – product of the project. E.g. number of people reached, area covered etc.
 - Measurable outcomes – expected achievement of the project. E.g. increase in prosecutions of crime against women, reduction in crime rate etc.

Central Victim Compensation Fund (CVCF)

- The Central Victim Compensation Fund (CVCF) was established under the Nirbhaya Fund Framework to assist states and union territories with their victim compensation schemes.
- The CVCF is a one-time grant of additional monies to the states/UTs in response to the Supreme Court's directives.

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Mahila Police Volunteers (MPVs)

- The Department of Home Affairs and the Ministry of Women and Child Development jointly launched the Mahila Police Volunteers Scheme in order to recruit MPVs in the States and UTs.
- It is a central sector initiative that seeks to link public aid for needy women with public policy.

Universalisation of Women Helpline

- All States and Union Territories now have access to short code 181, which is used as a women's helpline by a number of States and UTs, including Delhi, Chandigarh, and Chhattisgarh.
- Under this Scheme, States and UTs must designate this short code 181 as a women's helpline (WHL).

Latest project undertaken by various states and central government by utilising Nirbhaya fund

- The One Stop Center Scheme, commonly known as "Sakhi Centers," intends to create facilities to support women who have been subjected to violence.
- There are First Aid, Medical, Police, Legal, and Counseling Support services available.
- Mahila Police Volunteers (MPVs), who will act as a bridge between the police and the community, will provide assistance to women in need.
- Haryana is the first state where the Mahila Police Volunteer programme has officially begun.
- Through the nationalisation of the women's helpline, which will have a single number for the entire nation, One Stop Centers will be connected.
- To ensure that women and young girls are protected while being transported, the Andhra Pradesh government has suggested the Abhaya Project.

- **Chirali (Friends Forever):** This programme is utilised in the state of Rajasthan. Gram Panchayats construct Community Action Groups in accordance with the goal to foster an atmosphere that enables girls and women to roam freely and take advantage of opportunities for their well being.

Issues with Nirbhaya Fund

- The states' failure to use the Nirbhaya Fund has left the Center in a very convenient position, with Smriti Irani properly blaming the states.
- The Nirbhaya Fund was established to assist rape victims and to assure their rehabilitation. However, policy development is one thing, and policy execution is quite another.
- The administration has been accused of not putting the Nirbhaya Fund to good use. With the rise in sexual harassment and crime against women, such funding is badly needed.
- The central government's department of justice also donates to the Nirbhaya Fund. None of the states have used any of the funds made available to them by the Department of Justice.

Conclusion:

Legislators in both states and Parliament have attempted to echo the emotions of those who have taken to the streets to demand justice for the Hyderabad gangrape victim and others like her. However, those in authority have failed to keep the pledges made during the Nirbhaya protests and the establishment of the Nirbhaya Fund.

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